Life in the United Kingdom (3rd edition)

History Dates

10,000yrs	**Britain separated** — from the continent
6,000yrs	**First farmers** — come to Britain from South-East Europe
4,000yrs	**Bronze Age** — then becomes Iron Age
55BC	**Failed Roman invasion** — Julius Caesar attempts first Roman led invasion but fails
43AD	**Successful Roman invasion** — Emperor Claudius succesfully invaded Britain
410	**Romans end** — Roman army leaves to defend Rome and never returns
789	**Vikings** — came from Norway and Denmark, defeated by King Alfred the Great
1066	**Norman Conquest** — William (Duke of Normandy) the Conqueror wins Battle of Hastings and invades Britain
1215	**Magna Carta** — The King is subject to the Law
1284	**Statute of Rhuddlan** — King Edward I annexes Wales
1314	**Battle of Bannockburn** — Robert the Bruce (scots) wins
1348	**Black Death** — kills 1/3 of population. After which new class "the gentry" appeared, owners of large areas of land
1415	**Battle of Agincourt** — Henry V wins during the 100 years war against France
1455	**start of civil war** — houses Lanacaster (red rose) and York (white rose)
1485	**End War of the Roses** — Battle of Bosworth, Lancaster wins over York, Henry VII Tudor king, end of the Middle Ages
1560	**Scottish abolish the Pope**
1588	**Spanish Armada** — Elizabeth I defeats spanish invasion to convert to Catholicism
1603	**James I** — End of the Tudor period, James VI of Scotland becomes king
1605	**Guy Fawkes** — with catholics tries to bomb the Parliament to kill the protestant king on 5th of November
1642	**Civil war** — after Charles I asked Parliament for money, Cavaliers(king) and Roundheads(parliament)
1644	**Battle of Marston Moor** — king's army is defeated
1645	**Battle of Naseby** — king's army is defeated
1646	**End of the first Civil War**
1649	**Britain republic** — after Charles I is executed
1656	**first Jews in England** — since the Middle Ages
1658	**Lord Protector Oliver Cromwell dies**
1660	**Charles II comes back to be king** — hid in an oak tree after defeat at the Battle of Worcester (1651). Ends 11 years of republic, The Restoration
1665	**Plague**
1666	**Great Fire**
1679	**Habeas Corpus** — you must present the person in court
1685	**James II** — was James VII of Scotland, becomes king after Charles II dies
1688	**Glorious Revolution** — William of Orange invades England
1689	**Bill of Rights** — more control on the King, constitutional monarchy
1690	**Battle of the Boyne** — Protestant William III (Orange) defeats Catholic James II in Ireland. James flees to France again
1695	**Newspaper** — can operate without government licence
1707	**Act of Union** — Kingdom of Great Britain is created joining Scotland
1714	**King George I** — a german becomes king. His English was poor
1721	**Robert Walpole** — first Prime Minister
1745-46	**Bonnie Prince Charlie** — tries to get the throne with scots' help but looses at the battle of Culloden, after which Highland Cleareances
1776	**American colonies independence** — 13 colonies declare independence from UK
1783	**Britain recognise independence**
1789	**Revolution in France** — the new French government opposed Britain's monarchy. Napoleon comes later
1801	**Ireland unifies with UK** — Union Flag
1805	**Battle of Trafalgar** — Britain navy defeats spanish and france with admiral Nelson
1807	**Slave trade banned** — illegal to trade slaves in British ships or from British ports
1815	**Battle of Waterloo** — Duke of Wellington defeats Napoleon
1833	**Emancipation Act** — slavery abolished in the British Empire
1837	**Queen Victoria** — at the age of 18 will rule for 64 years Victorian age
1840	**Punch Magazine** — satirical magazine
1840s	**Irish famine** — potato crop failed. About 1 million people died
1846	**Abolishment of Corn Laws**
1851	**Great Exhibition** — in Hyde Park, Crystal Palace
1853-56	**Crimean Wars** — Britain, France and Turkey fight Russia. First conflict that was reported on with photographs.
1899-1902	**Boer Wars** — South Africa with Netherlands
1896	**first public screening of movies**
1902	**Motor-car racing in the UK started**
1914-18	**WW1** — assassination of Austrian Archduke Franz Ferdinand
1918	**end of WW1 at 11am on 11 November** — Remembrance Day silence is at 11am. Women over 30 can also vote
1922	**Ireland becomes 2 countries / BBC radio** — Northern Ireland is 6 counties and stays in the UK. The rest is the Irish Free State
1928	**women can vote at the same age of men, 21**
1929	**Great Depression**
1930s	**Turing Machine** — Alan Turing
1932	**invention of TV** — by scotsman John Logie Baird
1935	**invention of Radar** — by Sir Robert Watson-Watt
1936	**BBC first TV service**
1939	**WW2** — Germany invades Poland
1940	**Dunkirk** — evacuation of about 300,000 British and French troops as France falls. The "Dunkirk spirit"
1940	**Battle of Britain** — RAF defeats the German air force and prevents an invasion
1940	**The Blitz** — German bombing of British cities
1942	**Beveridge Report** — Social Insurance and Allied Services, basis of the welfare state
1944	**Butler Act** — free secondary education in England and Wales
1944	**D-Day** — Allies in Normandy to attack Germans
1945	**end of WW2** — German defeat, atom bomb in Japan
1945	**Labour Government** — Clement Attlee is PM, nationalisation of industries and strong welfare
1947	**colonies independent** — Britain give independence to 9 countries, including India, Pakistan and Ceylon(Sri Lanka)
1948	**NHS** — by minister Aneurin (Nye) Bevan
1949	**Republic of Ireland**
1951-64	**Conservative Government** — Winston Churchill returns as PM in 1951
1957	**EEC** — European Economic Community
1959	**Margaret Thatcher** — is MP, becomes leader of opposition in 1975

1969	**The Troubles** — in Northen Ireland, , 3000 people died those years, women and men can vote at 18
1972	**Northen Ireland parliament was suspended**
1973	**UK joins EEC**
1990	**WWW** — Sir Tim Berners-Lee
1990	**UK wars** — help liberate from Iraqi invasion of Kuwait and Former Republic of Yugoslavia
1990-97	**John Major** — Conservative PM after Margaret Thatcher. Helped start the Northern Ireland peace process
1997	**Tony Blair** — Labour government, creates Scottish Parliament and Welsh Assembly
1999	**Scottish Parliament. Hereditary peers lost automatic right to attend the House of Lords, they now elect a few of their memebers.**
2009	**Britain leaves Iraq**
2010	**no party won the election** — Conservative and Liberal Democrat parties formed a coalition led by David Cameron
2016	**Brexit Referendum** — 23 June
2020	**UK left the European Union** — 11pm GMT on 31 January. The transition ended at 11pm on 31 December

History facts

- By the middle of the 15th century the last Welsh rebellions had been defeated. English laws and the English language were introduced.
- Between 1680 and 1720 many refugees called **Huguenots** came from France. They were Protestants and had been persecuted for their religion. Many were educated and skilled and worked as scientists, in banking, or in weaving or other crafts.
- In the 1830s and 1840s, a group called the Chartists campaigned for reform. They wanted six changes:
  - for every man to have the vote
  - elections every year
  - for all regions to be equal in the electoral system
  - secret ballots
  - for any man to be able to stand as an MP
  - for MPs to be paid
- During the Middle Ages, the English kings also fought a number of wars abroad. Many knights took part in the Crusades, in which European Christians fought for control of the Holy Land. English kings also fought a long war with France, called the Hundred Years War (even though it actually lasted 116 years).

Important People

William (Duke of Normandy)	Defeats saxon King Harold, **Domesday Book** — 1066
King John	**Magna Carta** — 1215
King Edward I	**Statute of Rhuddlan** — 1284
Robert The Bruce	defeats english Battle of Bannockburn — 1314
King Henry V	beats French in Battle of Agincourt — 1415
Henry Tudor VII	wins War of the Roses — 1485
Henry VIII	6 wives (Catherine of Aragon, Anne Boleyn, Jane Seymour, Anne of Cleves, Catherine Howard, Catherine Parr) — 1509-47
Edward VI	strongly protestant, "Book of Common Prayer"
Bloody Mary	daughter of Catherine of Aragon
Elizabeth I	daughter of Anne Boleyn, defeats **Spanish Armada**, promotes patriotism — -1603
Sir Francis Drake	big role defeating the Spanish Armada, his Golden Hind is one of the first to circumnavigate earth
William Shakespeare	born in Stratford-upon-Avon was a playwright and actor and wrote poems and plays — 1564-1616
Mary Stuart	a week old when she became queen, went to England and remain in prison for 20 years and then executed
James I	of England Wales and Ireland, was VI of Scotland
Charles I	starts Civil War with Parliament loses and gets executed
Oliver Cromwell	Lord Protector during 11 years of Republic — -1658
Charles II	comes back to be king, interested in science forms Royal Society — -1685
Sir Edmund Halley	member of Royal Society, predicts the return of the Halley's Comet
Isaac Newton	studied at Cambridge, work on Philosophiae Naturalis Principia Mathematica — 1643-1727
James II	brother of Charles II, he is VII of Scotland, favours Catholics
William of Orange	husband of Mary, elder daughter of James II, invades England in 1688, defeats James II at the Battle of the Boyne, Bill of Rights
George I	a german becomes king — 1714-
Robert Walpole	**first prime minister** under George I — 1721-42
Charles Edward Stuart	Prince Bonnie Charlie grandson of James II tries to get back the throne from George II but loses
Robert Burns	scottish poet writes Auld Lang Syne (sang for new year) — 1759-96
Richard Arkwright	efficient running factories — 1731-92
James Watt	Steam power — 1736-1819
Sake Dean Mahomet	first **Curry House** in London and **Shampooing** (Indian head massage) — 1759-1851
Admiral Nelson	wins the **Battle of Trafalgar** at sea but dies in it. Trafalgar Square in London is named after it — 1805
Queen Victoria	Victorian period, biggest empire — 1837-1901
Isambard Kingdom Brunel	engineer started Great Western Railways and built bridges — 1806-59
Florence Nightingale	**nurse** in the Crimean War. Started the Nightingale Training School for nurses at St Thomas' Hospital in London — 1820-1910
Emmeline Pankhurst	**suffragettes**, movement for the right to vote for women. In 1918 women of 30 could vote and go to parliament. In 1928 women could vote at 21, like men — 1858-1928
Rudyard Kipling	write poems about India and UK, British Empire is a force for good, wrote **The Jungle Book** — 1865-1936
Winston Churchill	Conservative MP and then PM during the war, lost general election in 1945, but returned as PM in 1951 — 1874-1965
Alexander Fleming	discovers **penicillin** nobel prize in 1945 — 1881-1955
Clement Attlee	PM of Labour government after war, nationalisation of industries and strong welfare — 1883-1967
William Beveridge	**The Beveridge Report** (1942), Social Insurance and Allied Services, basis of the welfare state — 1879-1963
R. A. Butler	*The Butler Act* (1944), free secondary education in England and Wales — 1902-82
Dylan Thomas	welsh poet, *Under Milk Wood*and *Do Not Go Gentle into That Good Night* — 1914-53
John Logie Baird	scotsman to develop **TV** in 1920 and first broadcast London to Glasgow in 1932 — 1888-1946
Sir Rober Watson-Watt	develops **radar** 1935 — 1892-1973
Sir Bernard Lovell	astronomy discoveries and build a radio telescope at Jodrell Bank — 1913-2012
Alan Turing	**Turing Machine** — 1912-54
John Macleod	co-discoverer of **insulin** to treat diabetes — 1876-1935
Francis Crick	one of those awarded the Nobel prize for the discovery of the **structure of the DNA molecule**, in 1953 London and Cambridge universities — 1916-2014
Sir Frank Whittle	developed **jet engine** in 1930 — 1907-96
Sir Christopher Cockerell	invented **hovercraft** 1950s

James Goodfellow	invented cash-dispensing **ATM** (automatic-teller machine) — 1937-
Sir Robert Edwards and Patrick Steptoe	invented **IVF (in-vitro fertilisation)**
Sir Ian Wilmut and Keith Campbell	led the team that achieved **cloning** of sheep Dolly — 1944-2023, 1954-2012
Sir Peter Mansfield	co-inventor of **MRI (magnetic resonance imaging)** scanner — 1933-
Sir Tim Berners-Lee	invented **World Wide Web** in 1990 — 1955-
Mary Peters	born in Manchester, moved to Northern Ireland as a child, won pentathlon Olympic gold in 1972 — 1939-
Margaret Thatcher	Conservative MP in 1959, became first woman PM in 1979, worked close with Ronald Regan and helped end Cold War — 1925-2013
John Major	Conservative PM after Thatcher (1990-97). Helped start the Northern Ireland peace process — 1943-
Roald Dahl	born in Wales from Norwegians wrote *Charlie and the Chocolate Factory* and *George's Marvellous Medicine* — 1916-90
James Cook	maps the coast of Australia
George and Robert Stephenson	pioneered the railway engine
St Columba	founded a monastery in the island of Iona off the coast of Scotland

Sport

Sir Roger Bannister	first men to rin a 1 mile in less than 4 minutes
Sir Jackie Stewart	scottish racing driver won Formula 1 3 times
Bobby Moore	captain the English football team winning the 1966 world cup
Sir Ian Botham	capitan of English Cricket team and winner of cricket records
Jayne Torvill and Christopher Dean	won gold medal in ice dancing at the 1984 Olympics
Sir Steve Redgrave	won gold medals in rowing in 5 consecutive Olympics
Baroness Tanni Grey-Thompson	wheelchair records, 11 gold medals
Dame Kelly Holmes	won 2 gold medals for running in 2004 Olympics
Dame Ellen MacArthur	yachtswoman, fastest person to sail single-handed around the world in 2004
Sir Chris Hoy	Scottish cyclist that won 6 gold and 1 silver Olympic medals and 11 world championships
David Weir	Paralympian with wheelchair has won 6 gold medals and London marathon 6 times
Sir Bradley Wiggins	cyclist, first Briton to win the Tour de France in 2012, won 7 Olympic medals including golds in 2004, 2008 and 2012
Mo Farah	won gold medals in the 5,000 and 10,000 metres at the 2012 Olympics
Jessica Ennis	won 2012 Olympic heptathlon
Andy Murray	Scottish tennis player won men's singles in US open in 2012, he won gold and silver medals at the Olympics
Ellie Simmonds	Paralympian won gold medals for swimming at 2008 and 2012 Paralympic Games, was the youngest member at the 2008 Games
Sir Francis Chichester	first person to sail single-handed around the world in 1966/67
Sir Robin Knox-Johnston	first person to sail single-handed around the world without stopping
Damon Hill	won the Formula 1 World Championship
Lewis Hamilton	won the Formula 1 World Championship
Jenson Button	won the Formula 1 World Championship

Sport facts

- The UK has hosted the Olympic Games on three occasions: **1908, 1948 and 2012**
- There are **5** ski resorts in Scotland

Music

Henry Purcell	organist at Westminster wrote church music and operas
George Frederick Handel	german that became english, composer for George I, also wrote an oratorio *Messiah* to be sung by choirs usually at Easter
Gustav Holst	composer, wrote *The Planets*
Sir Edward Elgar	*Pomp And Circumstance Marches*, *March N1*, played the last night at the *Proms* at the Royal Albert Hall
Ralph Vaughan Williams	wrote music for orchestras an choirs, influenced by traditional English folk music
Sir William Walton	wrote music for George VI and Elizabeth II, wrote from films scores to opera, best known for *Facade* that became a ballet and *Belshazzar's Feast*, intended to be sung by a large choir
Benjamin Britten	operas, *Peter Grimes* and *Billy Budd*, *A young Person's Guide to the Orchestra*

Art

Thomas Gainsborough	portrait painter, people in country or gardens
David Allan	Scottish painter, made The origin of Painting
Joseph Turner	landscape painter
John Constable	landscape painter
The Pre-Raphaelites	group of artists detailed pictures on religious or literary themes in bright colours, the group included Holman Hunt, Dante Gabriel Rossetti and Sir John Millais
Sir John Lavery	Northern Irish portrait painter, painted the Royal Family
Henry Moore	English sculptor , large bronze abstract sculptures
John Petts	welsh artist known for engravings and stained glass
Lucian Freud	German born British artist best know for his portraits
David Hockney	important contributor to the *Pop Art* movement of the 1960s

Architecture

William the Conqueror	ordered to build the Tower of London
Sir Christopher Wren	St Paul's Cathedral
Robert Adam	Scottish architect Dumfries House in Scotland, influences the Royal Crescent in Bath
Sir Edwin Lutyens	designed New Delhi, responsible for the memorial Cenotaph in Whitehall
Sir Norman Foster	modern British architect
Lord (Richard) Rogers	modern British architect
Dame Zaha Hadid	modern British architect
Lancelot 'Capability' Brown	designed country houses lands
Gertrude Jekyll	worked with Lutyens to design colourful gardens

Fashion and Design

Thomas Chippendale	designed forniture in the 18th century
Clarice Cliff	designed Art Deco ceramics
Sir Terence Conran	a 20th century interior designer
Mary Quant	leading fashion designer
Alexander McQueen	leading fashion designer
Vivienne Westwood	leading fashion designer

Literature

Sir William Golding	novelist, Nobel prize
Seamus Heaney	poet, Nobel prize
Harold Pinter	playwright, Nobel prize
Agatha Christie	wrote detective stories

Ian Fleming	wrote the James Bond stories, starting in the 1950s
J.R.R. Tolkien	*The Lord of the Rings*, voted the country's best-loved novel in 2003
Jane Austen	English novelist. *Pride and Prejudice* and *Sense and Sensibility*
Charles Dickens	wrote very famous novels like *Oliver Twist* and *Great Expectations*
Robert Louis Stevenson	books like *Treasure Island*, *Kidnapped* and *Dr Jekyll and Mr Hyde*
Thomas Hardy	author and poet, known for *Far from the Madding Crowd* and *Jude the Obscure*
Sir Arthur Conan Doyle	Scottish doctor and writer best know for stories about *Sherlock Holmes*
Evelyn Waugh	wrote satirical novels including *Decline and Fall* and *Scoop*, *Brideshead Revisited*
Sir Kingsley Amis	English novelist and poet, wrote more than 20 novels, *Lucky Jim*
Graham Greene	wrote novels influenced by religious beliefs, *The Heart of the Matter*, *The Honorary Consul*, *Brighton Rock*, *Our Man in Havana*
J K Rowling	wrote *Harry Potter* series
Ian McEwan	winner of Man Booker Prize for Fiction, best fiction novel in the Commonwealth Ireland or Zimbabwe
Hilary Mantel	winner of Man Booker Prize for Fiction, best fiction novel in the Commonwealth Ireland or Zimbabwe
Julian Barnes	winner of Man Booker Prize for Fiction, best fiction novel in the Commonwealth Ireland or Zimbabwe
-	*BeoWulf* Anglo-Saxon poem
Geoffrey Chaucer	Wrote poems called the *Canterbury Tales*, telling of Pilgrims that went from London to Canterbury
John Milton	protestant poems inspired by religious views, *Paradise Lost*
William Shakespeare	playwright and actor and wrote poems and plays (sonnets, poems of 14 lines)
William Wordsworth	poet inspired by nature, *The Daffodils*
Sir Walter Scott	poems inspired by Scotland
Robert Browning	*Home Thoughts from Abroad*
Lord Byron	*She Walks in Beauty*
William Blake	*The Tyger*
Wilfred Owen	*Anthem for Doomed Youth*, also wrote about his experiences during the war
Siegfried Sassoon	wrote about his experiences during the war
John Barbour	scottish poet

Literature Facts

- in 2003 JRR Tolkien's *The Lord of the Rings* is voted the country's most loved novel

Cinema

Colin Firth	Oscar winner
Sir Anthony Hopkins	Oscar winner
Dame Judi Dench	Oscar winner
Kate Winslet	Oscar winner
Tilda Swinton	Oscar winner
Sir Alfred Hitchcock	famous director, *The 39 steps*
David Lean	directed *Brief encounter* and *Lawrence of Arabia*
Carol Reed	directed *The Third Man*
Frank Launder	directed *The Bells of St Trinian's*
Ken Russel	directed *Women in Love*
Nicolas Roeg	*Don't Look Now*
Hugh Hudson	directed *Chariots of FIre*
Roland Joffe	directed *The Killing Fields*
Mike Newell	directed *Four Weddings and a Funeral*
Kevin MacDonald	directed *Touching the void*
Nick Park	*Wallace and Gromit* animated movies

Cinema facts

- Recent British actors to have won Oscars include Colin Firth, Sir Anthony Hopkins, Dame Judi Dench, Kate Winslet and Tilda Swinton.
- British studios flourished in the 1930s. The 1950s and 1960s were a high point for British comedies, including *Passport to Pimlico*, *The Ladykillers* and, later, the *Carry On* films.

Religion

70%	**Christian** — 2009 Citizenship Survey, the figures the test uses
4%	**Muslim** — Eid al-Fitr (end of Ramadan) and Eid ul Adha (remembers that prophet Ibrahim was willing to sacrifice his son)
2%	**Hindu** — celebrates Diwali
1%	**Sikh** — Vaisakhi festival celebrated on 14th of April, also celebrates Diwali
<0.5%	**Jewish** — Hanukkah is a Jewish celebration in November or December and lasts 8 days
<0.5%	**Buddhist**
2%	**Other**
21%	**No religion**

Religion facts

- Protestant Christian groups are: Baptists Methodists, **Presbyterians(Scotland)** and Quakers
- The Church of England is known as the **Episcopal** Curch in USA and Scotland

Countries characteristics

Country	Population	Day	Saint	Flower	Food	Capital
Wales	5%	1st March	St David	Daffodil	welsh cakes (flour dried fruits and spices)	Cardiff
North Ireland	<3%	17th March	St Patrick	Shamrock	Ulster fry (bacon, eggs, sausage, black pudding, white pudding, tomatoes, mushrooms, soda bread and potato bread)	Belfast
England	84%	23rd April	St George	Rose	roast beef (served with potatoes, vegetables), Yorkshire puddings, fish and chips, fish and chips	London
Scotland	8%	30th November	St Andrew	Thisle	haggis (sheep's stomach stuffed with offal, suet, onions and oatmeal)	Edinburg

Numbers

1600	**> 4 mil**
1700	**5 mil**
1801	**8 mil**
1851	**20 mil**
1901	**40 mil**
1951	**50 mil**
1998	**57 mil**
2005	**< 60 mil**
2010	**> 62 mil**

2017	**> 66 mil**

Places

Vindolanda	Roman fort near Hadrian's Wall
Housesteads	part of Hadrian Wall
Bodnant Garden	Wales
Millennium Stadium	Cardiff
Maiden Castle	Dorset - Iron Age hill fort
York Minster	has windows of stained glass about Bible and Christian saints
Stonehenge	Stone Age monument in Wiltshire
Skara Brae	Stone Age prehistoric Village on Orkney
Sutton Hoo	Anglo-Saxon king burial site in a ship under earth, in Suffolk

General Facts

- 15 national parks in the UK
- It takes about **1 hour** to donate blood
- MOT for cars older than **3 years**
- Mothering Sunday (or Mother's Day) is the Sunday three weeks before Easter.
- The King is the ceremonial head of the Commonwealth, which currently has **54** member states.
- The UN has 190 member states
- The currency in the UK is the pound sterling (symbol £). There are 100 pence in a pound. The denominations (values) of currency are:
  - coins: 1p, 2p, 5p, 10p, 20p, 50p, £1 and £2
  - notes: £5, £10, £20, £50.
- Some of the principles included in the European Convention on Human Rights are:
  - right to life
  - prohibition of torture
  - prohibition of slavery and forced labour
  - right to liberty and security
  - right to a fair trial
  - freedom of thought, conscience and religion
  - freedom of expression (speech).
- The chairperson of the General Assembly of the Church of Scotland is the **Moderator**, who is appointed for **one year** only and often speaks on behalf of that Church.
- Big Ben is the nickname for the great bell of the clock at the Houses of Parliament in London. Many people call the clock Big Ben as well. The clock is over 150 years old and is a popular tourist attraction. The clock tower is named 'Elizabeth Tower' in honour of Queen Elizabeth II's **Diamond Jubilee in 2012**.
- Serious civil cases are dealt in the **High Court** in England, Wales and Northern Ireland and for Scotland, in the **Court of Session in Edinburgh**

National Anthem

Starts with:

> *God save our gracious King!*
> *Long Live our noble King!*
> *God save the King!*
> *Send him victorious,*
> *Happy and glorious,*
> *Long to reign over us,*
> *God save the King!*

Government

Devolved administrations

Name	Creation	Members	NMembers	Details
Senedd (Welsh Parliament)		Senedd Members (SMs)	60	elections every 4 years, building is the Senedd
Scottish Parliament	1999	Members of the Scottish Parliament (MSPs)	129	
Northern Ireland Parliament	1922			Abolished in 1972
Northern Ireland Assembly	1998	Members of the Legislative Assembly (MLAs) meet in the Northern Ireland Assembly at Stormont, Belfast	90	

Government and politics facts

- Polling stations are open from **7am to 10pm**. Staff ask for your name and address. In Northern Ireland you will also have to show photographic identification. You then get your ballot paper, which you take to a polling booth to fill in privately
- The Prime Minister appoints about **20** senior MPs to become ministers in charge of departments:
  - **Chancellor of the Exchequer** – responsible for the economy
  - **Home Secretary** – responsible for crime, policing and immigration
  - **Foreign Secretary** – responsible for managing relationships with foreign countries
  - other ministers (called '**Secretaries of State**') responsible for subjects such as education, health and defence.
- The House of Lords can suggest amendments or propose new laws, which are then discussed by MPs. It checks laws that have been passed by the House of Commons to ensure they are fit for purpose. It also holds the government to account to make sure that it is working in the best interests of the people.
- Since 1958, the Prime Minister has had the power to nominate peers just for their own lifetime. These are called life peers. They have usually had an important career in politics, business, law or another profession. Life peers are appointed by the monarch on the advice of the Prime Minister.
- Since 1999, hereditary peers have lost the automatic right to attend the House of Lords. The Reform Act of 1832 had greatly increased the number of people with the right to vote. The Act also abolished the old pocket and rotten boroughs and more parliamentary seats were given to the towns and cities.
- MPs have a number of different responsibilities. They:
  - represent everyone in their constituency
  - help to create new laws
  - scrutinise and comment on what the government is doing
  - debate important national issues
- As well as getting the right to vote, people on the electoral register are randomly selected to serve on a jury. Anyone who is on the electoral register and is aged **18 to 70** can be asked to do this.
- The Speaker of the House is politically Neutral and voted in by Secret Ballot by other MPs (not by everyone in the UK!), but are still Members of Parliament and still represent their constituency.
- In November 2012, the public elected Police and Crime Commissioners (PCCs) in England and Wales.

Judiciary and Courts

- Police and Crime Commissioners (PCCs) were first elected by the public in England and Wales in November 2012.
- Small claims procedure - less than £10,000 in England and Wales, and £5,000 in Scotland and Northern Ireland. Minor disputes without spending lots of time and money, no solicitors. Judge with both parties in a small room, or online at moneyclaim.gov.uk

Type of Courts	Severity	England, Wales and Northern Ireland	Scotland
Criminal	Minor	Magistrates Court - Unpaid Magistrates are part of community, NI has district Judges and are paid	Justices of the Peace
Criminal	Major	Crown Court - Judge and Jury (12pax)	Sheriff Court - Sheriff or Sheriff and Jury (15pax)
Criminal	Murders		High Court
Civil	Minor	County Court	Sheriff Court
Civil	Major	High Court	Court of Session in Edinburgh
Youth		Youth Court - up to 3 specially trained magistrates or 1 District Judge. No public or media	Children's Hearing System
Youth	Serious	Crown Court	